

10 PREDICTIONS FOR 2021

(Sermon notes for January 3, 2021)

TEXT: 1 Peter 1:22-25 (NKJV) *“Since you have purified your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit in sincere love of the brethren, love one another fervently with a pure heart, ²³having been born again, not of corruptible seed but incorruptible, through the word of God which lives and abides forever, ²⁴because “All flesh is as grass, And all the glory of man as the flower of the grass. The grass withers, And its flower falls away, ²⁵But the word of the LORD endures forever.”*
Hebrews 13:8 (NKJV) *“Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever.”*

INTRO: Today’s world is filled with all kinds of uncertainty:

- Uncertainty about the future...
- Uncertainty about the economy...
- Uncertainty about government...

- Uncertainty about eternity...

The uncertainty of the world's situation results in the population of the planet living at a stress level which no other generation has ever before experienced. The greatest side effect of a world filled with uncertainty is the loss of hope. The Word of God tells us “*Hope is the anchor of the soul.*” When the anchor of one's life has been disabled, the winds of uncertainty will most certainly have a devastating result. Diuna Barnes said, “*Certainty is a stop the mind makes between uncertainties.*”

Though the world is filled with uncertainty, I want to talk to you for the next few Sundays about ten predictions for 2021.

PREDICTION #1 - THE WORD OF GOD WILL CONTINUE TO BE THE MOST POWERFUL FORCE ON THE PLANET

There are many powerful forces on the earth but the most powerful force on the earth is the Word

of God! Hebrews 4:12 (NKJV) *“For the word of God is living and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword, piercing even to the division of soul and spirit, and of joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.”*

The Word of God:

- Is a devouring flame... Jeremiah 5:14
- Is a crushing hammer... Jeremiah 23:29
- Is a life-giving force... Ezekiel 37:7
- Is a saving power... Romans 1:16
- Is a defensive weapon... Ephesians 6:17
- Is a probing instrument... Hebrews 4:12

No matter what else changes, the Word of God will remain the most powerful force on the earth.

Abraham Lincoln said, *“I am busily engaged in the study of the Bible. I believe it is God’s word because it finds me where I am.”*

Abraham Lincoln also said, *“I believe the Bible is the best gift God has ever given to man. All the good of the Savior of the world is communicated to us through the Book.”*

I predict those who stand on the Word will continue to see the power of the Word at work in 2021!

PREDICTION # 2 - THE WORLD WILL CONTINUE TO BE A SAFE PLACE FOR THE CHRISTIAN

A large part of the world’s population is concerned about their safety! Political campaigns have been predicated on asking *“Do you feel safe?”*

The inference is that if we elect the right candidate, they will keep us safe. No candidate can give that assurance in today’s world! Chris Coleman said, *“We can’t feel safe because we are not safe.”*

We live in a dangerous world! 2 Timothy 3:1-5 (NKJV) ***“But know this, that in the last days perilous times will come: ²For men will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boasters, proud, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy, ³unloving, unforgiving, slanderers, without self-control, brutal, despisers of good, ⁴traitors, headstrong, haughty, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, ⁵having a form of godliness but denying its power. And from such people turn away!”*** This sounds like a local news cast or the latest newspaper headline! Any way you slice it, we live in a dangerous world!

Though the world around us is dangerous the Children of God are as safe as we can be, because our destiny is in the hands of the Lord!

Why should Christians feel secure in dangerous times?

- The presence of the Lord undergirds us... *“Underneath are His everlasting arms...”*
- The presence of the Lord overshadows us... *“The shadow of His hand...”*
- The presence of the Lord is beside us... *“Like a shade on our right hand and left hand...”*
- The presence of the Lord is behind us... *“He is our rear guard...”*
- The presence of the Lord goes before us... *“The steps of good people are ordered by the Lord...”*
- The presence of the Lord is all around us... *“Like a hen protects her chickens...”* *“He’s got the whole world in His hand...”*

The Child of God has nothing to fear because our lives are in the hand of the Lord!

I predict the world will continue to be a safe place for the children of God in 2021!

(End of Sermon notes for January 3, 2021)

PREDICTION # 3 - SIN WILL CONTINUE TO OFFEND GOD

(Sermon notes for January 10, 2021)

TEXT: 1 Peter 1:22-25 (NKJV) *“Since you have purified your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit in sincere love of the brethren, love one another fervently with a pure heart, ²³having been born again, not of corruptible seed but incorruptible, through the word of God which lives and abides forever, ²⁴because “All flesh is as grass, And all the glory of man as the flower of the grass. The grass withers, And its flower falls away, ²⁵But the word of the LORD endures forever.”*
Hebrews 13:8 (NKJV) *“Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever.”*

In the present church culture sin has been downgraded to:

- A gaffe...
- A blunder...
- A mistake...
- A misstep...
- An error...
- An unwise choice...

Not only do many ministers refuse to identify what constitutes a sinful practice, they refuse to even use the word sin! Sin has been downgraded to an acceptable blunder, and sinners have been upgraded to individuals who have had a run of bad luck!

The worst word in the human vocabulary is not a four-letter word; it is a three-letter word, SIN! No matter how much the church attempts to window dress the presence of sin in the world, God:

- Hates sin...
- Is offended by sin...
- Cannot look upon sin...

- Refuses to be connected to sinful practices...
- Cannot continue to be in fellowship with people who practice a lifestyle of sin...

The church needs its ministers to stand up boldly and cry against the sin of the world, AS WELL AS THE SIN OF THE CHURCH! 2 Chronicles 7:14 ***“If my people who are called by my name shall humble themselves and pray, and turn from THEIR WICKED WAYS...”***

The measure of success for a Pastor is not the number of people he/she can get to come to a church, but how many people they can get to Heaven. My goal for CT Church is that *“Every person in attendance the Sunday after the rapture will be a visitor!”*

Sin:

- Offends the Holiness of God...
- Breaks the relationship between God and man...

- Prevents the blessings of God from becoming a reality...
- Brings death to all who are involved...
- Dooms the soul to hell...

Benjamin Franklin said, “*Sin is not harmful because it is forbidden, it is forbidden because it is harmful!*”

It makes no difference how uncertain a preacher or church is about the issue of sin, it still offends the holiness of God! James 1:15 (NKJV)

“Every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed. ¹⁵Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death.”

I predict sin will be as offensive as ever to God in 2021!

**PREDICTION # 4 – GOD WILL
CONTINUE TO LOVE SINNERS**

God hates sin and the Church has a mandate to cry out in protest against its practices in the culture! Though this is true, one thing is for sure, God loves sinners and the Church should do so as well! John 3:16 (NKJV) ***“For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life. ¹⁷“For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but that the world through Him might be saved.”*** The purpose and heart of God are revealed in this passage of Scripture.

God easily does what His Church has had difficulty doing, distinguishing between sin and the sinner. The sinner is precious in the sight of God, but sin is deplorable to Him!

The love of God:

- Is wide enough to reach the wretches in the far-flung corners of the earth...
- Is high enough to capture the hearts of the up and coming...

- Is deep enough to break the fall of the down-and-outers...
- Is large enough to take a heart that has been darkened by the deceitfulness of sin, wash it in the red blood of Jesus, and make it white as snow...
- Is small enough to take up residence in the heart of a person who will allow the love of God to be demonstrated through them...

God loves sinners! ***“He is not willing that any should perish, but that all would come to repentance.”*** Saint Augustine said, *“God loves each of us as if there were only one of us!”*

When it comes to the love of God, we can:

- Sing about it and never understand it...
- Discuss it and never exhaust it...
- Debate it and never fully comprehend it...
- Receive it and never fully grasp it...
- Display it and never really have a handle on it...

- Ignore it and never outrun it...

The love of God is:

- Color blind...
- Unconscious of nationality...
- Gender neutral...
- Oblivious to educational achievements...
- Unaware of socio-economic status...

Biblical examples of the recipients of the love of God:

- Abraham... A liar!
- Moses... A murderer!
- Jacob... A deceiver!
- Samson... A womanizer!
- David... A murderer and womanizer!
- Rahab... A prostitute!
- Woman at the well... A home wrecker!
- Paul... A persecutor of the Church!

Who deserves the love of God? No one! Who is qualified to receive the love of God? Everyone!

Song: The Love Of God:

1. *The love of God is greater far
Than tongue or pen can ever tell;
It goes beyond the highest star,
And reaches to the lowest hell;
The guilty pair, bowed down with care,
God gave His Son to win;
His erring child He reconciled,
And pardoned from his sin.*
 - Refrain:
*Oh, love of God, how rich and pure!
How measureless and strong!
It shall forevermore endure—
The saints' and angels' song.*
 -
2. *When earthly time shall pass away,
And earthly thrones and kingdoms fall,
When men who here refuse to pray,
On rocks and hills and mountains call,*

*God's love so sure, shall still endure,
All measureless and strong;
Redeeming grace to Adam's race—
The saints' and angels' song.*

◦ Refrain:

*Oh, love of God, how rich and pure!
How measureless and strong!
It shall forevermore endure—
The saints' and angels' song.*

◦

3. *Could we with ink the ocean fill,
And were the skies of parchment made,
Were every stalk on earth a quill,
And every man a scribe by trade;
To write the love of God above
Would drain the ocean dry;
Nor could the scroll contain the whole,
Though stretched from sky to sky.*

◦ Refrain:

*Oh, love of God, how rich and pure!
How measureless and strong!
It shall forevermore endure—
The saints' and angels' song.*

Here is a life changing truth: C.S. Lewis said,
*“We have never looked eyes with anyone God
doesn’t love.”*

I have a word from God for each of us today,
*“God loves us too much to leave us like we
are.”*

I predict the Love of God will be as available as
it has ever been in 2021!

(End of sermon notes for January 10, 2021)

**PREDICTION # 5 - PRAYER WILL
CONTINUE TO BE THE MOST
EFFECTIVE THING A CHRISTIAN CAN
DO**

**(Susan will preach on prayer on January 17,
2021 – The following are my notes on prayer
but Susan will have her own notes)**

Prayer is one of the most taught and least
practiced of all theological topics. The

Christian is never as powerful as they are when they are praying! Praying Christians accomplish far more over a lifetime than do their non-praying counterparts!

A.J. Gordon said, *"We can do more than pray after we have prayed; but we can never do more than pray until we have prayed."*

Prayer is:

- Communication with God...
- A deterrent to sinful behavior...
- Filled with endless opportunity...
- A sure path to personal humility...
- A voltage regulator on the power gift...
- The only path to the throne room of God...

Requirements for receiving answers to prayer:

- Faith... Mark 11:24
- Contrition... 2 Chronicles 7:14
- Obedience... 1 John 3:22
- Righteousness... James 5:16

- Whole-heartedness... Jeremiah 29:13

E. M. Bounds said, *“God shapes the world by prayer. The more prayer there is in the world the better the world will be.”*

Biblical examples of answered prayer:

- Moses... Prayed repeatedly for provision and protection in the wilderness, and God answered with the opening of the Red Sea; a cloud of fire and smoke; water from a rock; quail and manna from heaven; and supernatural protection from their enemies.
- Gideon... Prayed and his fleece was wet and dry according to his prayers; with 300 men he defeated the host of the Midianites.
- Hannah... Prayed for a son and God gave her the desire of her heart.
- Elijah... Prayed and it did not rain for 3 ½ years! He prayed again and it rained! He prayed and fire fell from Heaven and consumed the sacrifice, wood, stones and the dust around the altar!

- Hezekiah... Prayed and God added 15 years to his life!
- Nehemiah... Prayed and defeated Sanballat and Tobiah! He reconstructed an entire city in 52 days without the use of modern equipment!
- Jesus... Prayed and miracles, signs, and wonders followed Him!
- The first century church... Prayed and signs, wonders, and miracles followed them! They were able to evangelize and disciple the world in one generation!
- Paul... Prayed and received protection and provision, as well as success against all odds! He persevered to the end!
- John... Prayed before being boiled in oil and banished to Patmos! God answered his prayer and delivered him from the hands of wicked men and gave him the greatest Revelation ever given to a man!

Sidlow Baxter said, *"Men may spurn our appeals, reject our message, oppose our*

arguments, despise our persons, but they are helpless against our prayers."

The next time the enemy attempts to make us feel as if prayer is not enough, we should remind ourselves that prayer is the most powerful thing a Christian can do!

I predict praying Christians will continue to be a force to be reckoned with in 2021!

(End of sermon notes for January 17, 2021 – These are my notes on prayer – Susan will be preaching on this Sunday and will have her own notes)

PREDICTION # 6 - THE GRACE OF GOD WILL CONTINUE TO BE EXTENDED TO HIS CHILDREN

(Sermon notes for January 24, 2021)

TEXT: 1 Peter 1:22-25 (NKJV) *“Since you have purified your souls in obeying the truth*

through the Spirit in sincere love of the brethren, love one another fervently with a pure heart, ²³having been born again, not of corruptible seed but incorruptible, through the word of God which lives and abides forever, ²⁴because “All flesh is as grass, And all the glory of man as the flower of the grass. The grass withers, And its flower falls away, ²⁵But the word of the LORD endures forever.”
Hebrews 13:8 (NKJV) “*Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever.”*

Mercy is not getting what we do deserve; punishment for sins committed! Grace is getting what we do not deserve; the blessings of God!

The word grace is mentioned one hundred seventy times in the King James Version of the Bible. This is a very, very important subject!

The greatest gift available to mankind is the grace of God! Dwight Moody said, “*Grace*

isn't a little prayer we chant before receiving a meal. It's a way to live. The law tells us how crooked we are. Grace comes along and straightens us out."

Until Christ finished His work on the cross grace was only something which was a figment of man's wildest imagination! Once His work was finished on the cross, grace became a reality to all humankind!

Think of grace in this way:

- Grace covers us when we deserve it the least...
- Grace releases us from our fiercest bondages...
- Grace opens up doors for us which were permanently shut...
- Grace provides a way of escaping judgment...
- Grace intervenes when sin is present...
- Grace delivers when the enemy persists...
- Grace proves our faith and salvation...

- Grace allows us a chance at heaven...

In our culture we are conditioned to believe
“*We get what you pay for.*” The thing about
grace is:

- We cannot earn it...
- We cannot purchase it...
- We cannot be good enough to deserve it...
- We cannot work hard enough to be worthy of it...
- We cannot be acquainted with enough people to negotiate it...

Dwight Moody said, “*A man can no more take in a supply of grace for the future than he can eat enough today to last him for the next 6 months, nor can he inhale sufficient air into his lungs with one breath to sustain life for a week to come. We are permitted to draw upon God's store of grace from day to day as we need it.*”

Psalms 103:1-6 (NKJV) “*Bless the Lord, O my soul; And all that is within me, bless His holy*

name! 2 Bless the Lord, O my soul, And forget not all His benefits: 3 Who forgives all your iniquities, Who heals all your diseases, 4 Who redeems your life from destruction, Who crowns you with lovingkindness and tender mercies, 5 Who satisfies your mouth with good things, So that your youth is renewed like the eagle's. 6 The Lord executes righteousness And justice for all who are oppressed.”

Psalms 23:6 (NKJV) “Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me All the days of my life; And I will dwell in the house of the Lord Forever.”

How do we receive grace? Ephesians 2:8 (NKJV) “*For by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹*not of works, lest anyone should boast.*” We receive grace by accepting it as a gift!*

The Scripture tells us it is possible to frustrate the grace of God! Galatians 2:20-21 (KJV) ***“I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me. ²¹I do not frustrate the grace of God: for if righteousness come by the law, then Christ is dead in vain.”*** If grace is a gift from God, how could one frustrate this gift? The grace of God is frustrated if we:

- Add to it...
- Restrict it...
- Take away from it...
- Delineate from its power...
- Relegate it to an inferior position...

I predict God will continue to extend His grace in 2021! The only question which remains is whether we will receive it?

PREDICTION # 7 – THE PROVISION OF GOD WILL CONTINUE TO BE AVAILABLE TO HIS PEOPLE

The provision of God is something that is clearly seen throughout the Word of God. It is amazing to see how God provided for His people in times which appeared to be impossible. When all help had been ruled out, God came through! Someone said, *“God never comes too late or with too little, He is always right on time with more than enough!”*

God provides in at least three distinct ways:

- Overtly – This is an unmistakable, undeniable miracle...
- Covertly – This occurs by providence or outside influence...
- Mysteiously – This is a deeper level of intervention than our minds can comprehend. At this level of provision, He has been at work behind the scenes arranging hundreds of details and schedules

to bring about Mysterious intervention at just the right moment!

God provided for:

- Abraham... (Covertly) As he traveled around “*Looking for a city which hath foundations...*”
- Elijah in a time of famine... (Overtly) The brook Cherith; ravens fed him!
- Widow of Zarephath... (Overtly) Made a cake for Elijah and the meal never wasted from the barrel!
- Four leprous men... (Mysteriously) At the gate of Samaria!
- Feeding of five thousand... (Overtly) 5,000 men plus the women and children!

God’s provision during the wilderness wandering of the Children of Israel is an interesting combination of the overt, covert and mysterious provision of God! God performed the miracle of provision so consistently that they assumed this was a normal way of life. When

we read the story of Jehovah's dealings with the Children of Israel, we take for granted the miracle of His provision! Look at the daily miracle of provision:

- The camp of Israel was two thirds the size of Rhode Island and covered 750 square miles...
- God provided approximately 4,000 tons of food per day...
- Transporting the food would require a freight train 2 miles long each day...
- The cost of the food would be approximately \$6,000,000.00 (M) per day...
- An adequate water supply would equate to 11,000,000 (M) gallons per day...
- The cost of water would be \$60,000.00 per day...
- Transporting the water would require a freight train 1,800 miles long each day...

God provided for them for 40 years or 14,600 days! This required:

- 58,400,000 (M) tons of food at a cost of \$87,600,000,000.00 (B)...
- 160,600,000,000 (B) gallons of water at a cost of \$876,000,000.00 (M)...
- Total cost of food and water would be \$88,476,000,000.00 (B)...
- Transportation for food and water would require a freight train 26,309,200 (M) miles long and would reach around the earth 106 times...

Charles Spurgeon once quipped, *"We believe in the providence of God, but we do not believe half enough in it."*

While we do believe in the providence of God, we have a most difficult time waiting for the promise! Hebrews 10:36 (KJV) ***"For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise."***

Vance Havner once said, *"God marks across some of our days, 'Will explain later.'"*

Some folks would say that they cannot receive the provision of God because they have nothing for Him to work with! Is that right? You have nothing? Nothing is exactly what God made the world of!

- God came from nowhere because there was nowhere to come from...
- God stood on nothing at creation because there was nothing to stand on...
- God reached out where there was nowhere to reach, and hung something upon nothing, spun the earth into orbit and told it to stay there, and it did...

I predict God will provide for us in 2021!

(End of sermon notes for January 24, 2021)

**PREDICTION # 8 - THE HOLY SPIRIT
WILL CONTINUE TO BUILD THE
CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST**

(Sermon notes for January 31, 2021)

TEXT: Matthew 16:13-19 (NKJV) *“When Jesus came into the region of Caesarea Philippi, He asked His disciples, saying, “Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?”¹⁴ So they said, “Some say John the Baptist, some Elijah, and others Jeremiah or one of the prophets.”¹⁵ He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?”¹⁶ Simon Peter answered and said, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”¹⁷ Jesus answered and said to him, “Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but My Father who is in heaven.¹⁸ “And I also say to you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build My church, and the gates of Hades shall not prevail against it.¹⁹ “And I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven,*

and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.” (USE ROCK FROM CAESAREA PHILIPPI AS A VISUAL AID)

In this passage of scripture, Jesus makes a bold and forward-thinking prediction concerning the Church He was about to birth. Actually, this is the vision statement for the New Testament Church!

Jesus lets us know that what He is predicting is not something which may or may not come to pass, but that it WILL be fulfilled!

The “*I*” here is the same “*I am*” which sent Moses to Egypt. He is the:

- Eternal one... (“*From everlasting to everlasting*”)
- All powerful one... (“*All power has been given unto me in Heaven and in Earth*”)
- Self-existent one... (“*He is the Lord of*

Glory and beside Him there is no other”)

- All knowing one... (***“The knowledge of the Lord will fill the Earth as the waters cover the sea”***)
- Omnipresent one... (***“The eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the Earth, seeking someone to whom He might show Himself strong”***)

Jesus, the great ***“I Am”*** is the founder and finisher of the Church!

The verb ***“will”*** is in future tense! He is saying the building of the Church ***“will”*** unquestionably come to pass. The reason the construction of the Church is so secure is because He (Jesus) is the architect and builder!

To begin with, no man can build God a church! He is building His own church!

Some folks think they are the builder when in fact; we are the material being used in the construction process of the Church!

Ephesians 2:19-22 (NKJV) ***“You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God, ²⁰having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone, ²¹in whom the whole building, being joined together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord, ²²in whom you also are being built together for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.”***

In building His Church God uses the broken, the blistered, and splintered, He does not reject anyone. (My Dad taught me to use everything in the building of a house – Very little scraps – Crown all the lumber)

If Jesus died to build His church, I predict He would take a very dim view of anyone seizing ownership of it. How would we view a person coming to our house every week and tearing boards and roofing off? This is His Church and His alone!

Three stages of the Church are clearly seen in Scripture:

- The concept of the Church was initiated in the age of guilt! Ephesians 1:4 (NKJV) **“He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before Him in love.”**
- The Church is being supernaturally constructed in the Dispensation of Grace! Colossians 3:1-4 (NKJV) **“If then you were raised with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ is, sitting at the**

right hand of God. ²Set your mind on things above, not on things on the earth. ³For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. ⁴When Christ who is our life appears, then you also will appear with Him in glory.”

- The completion of the Church will occur in the final age! Revelation 21:1-7 (NKJV)
“Now I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away. Also there was no more sea. ²Then I, John, saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. ³And I heard a loud voice from heaven saying, “Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and He will dwell with them, and they shall be His people. God Himself will be with them and be their God.”

Not too long after Jesus made the assertive prediction “*I will build my church*” the Holy Spirit was poured out in the upper room and the building of the Church got off to a swift start:

- 3,000 were saved the first day... (Acts 2:37-38)
- God added to the church daily such as should be saved... (Acts 2:47)
- 2,000 were saved at Solomon’s Porch... (Acts 3:1-4)
- The Samaritans became Christians... (Acts 8:1-12)
- Men and women were baptized following their conversion... (Acts 8:12-13)
- The Ethiopian eunuch was converted... (Acts 8:36-39)
- Saul (Paul) received Christ... (Acts 9:18)
- The household of Cornelius became

Christians... (Acts 10:43)

- The people of Antioch were converted... (Acts 11:19-21)
- Sergius Paulus became a Christian... (Acts 13:4-12)
- Many Jews and religious proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas at Antioch... (Acts 13:13-48)
- A great multitude of individuals followed Christ at Iconium... (Acts 14:1)
- An undetermined number of people made decisions for Christ at Lystra and Derbe... (Acts 14)
- The Philippian jailer and his family became followers of Christ... (Acts 16)
- Lydia came to faith in Christ... (Acts 16)
- A great multitude of the Greeks and many of the leading women joined themselves to the faith at Thessalonica... (Acts 17:1-12)

- The Athenians were converted at Mars Hill... (Acts 17:16-34)
- Many Corinthian people were converted... (Acts 18:8)
- At Corinth, Aquila and Pricilla followed Jesus... (Acts 18:24-28)
- The twelve disciples of John the Baptist were converted... (Acts 19:1-10)

(The Lord spoke to me and said, “*A book of Acts Church is one who has people saved daily.*”)

According to adherents.com there are more than two Billion Christians in the world today! Christianity outdistances the second place religion, Islam, by more than 600 Million!

Jesus said, “*I will build my Church.*”

- He has...
- He is...
- He will...

We have been invited to be a part of building His Church in the Earth; we need to be securing building materials for His Church. (Soul winning – Evangelism - Missions)

I predict He will continue to build His Church in 2021! I want to be a part of His Church, don't you?

(End of sermon notes for January 31, 2021)

**PREDICTION # 9 - GOD WILL
CONTINUE TO LIVE IN THE PRAISES
OF HIS PEOPLE**

(Sermon notes for February 7, 2021)

TEXT: Psalms 22:3 (NKJV) “*You are holy, Enthroned in the praises of Israel.*” The saints of God are spiritual Israel having been grafted into the vine, through the sacrifice of Christ.

Ephesians 2:11-22 (NKJV) “*Remember that you, once Gentiles in the flesh—who are called Uncircumcision by what is called the Circumcision made in the flesh by hands—¹²that at that time you were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope and without God in the world.*

¹³*But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ.* ¹⁴*For He Himself is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of separation, ¹⁵having abolished in His flesh the enmity, that is, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, so as to create in Himself one new man from the*

two, thus making peace, ¹⁶and that He might reconcile them both to God in one body through the cross, thereby putting to death the enmity. ¹⁷And He came and preached peace to you who were afar off and to those who were near. ¹⁸For through Him we both have access by one Spirit to the Father. ¹⁹Now, therefore, you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God, ²⁰having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone, ²¹in whom the whole building, being joined together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord, ²²in whom you also are being built together for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.” According to this scripture, through the sacrifice of Jesus, we have the same standing in the presence of God as our Jewish counterparts. If we have the same standing, our praise also produces the same effect as the praises of the Jewish people; they take us into the Holy Place

where God is enthroned in the praises of His people!

Praise always precedes victory! In Second Chronicles chapter 20 Jehoshaphat called a counsel of war and the decision was made, the battle strategy against the enemy would be to appoint singers to go out ahead of the army singing praise to God! (There was no fussing over who was going to be on the praise team that day!) 2 Chronicles 20:21 (NKJV) ***“When he had consulted with the people, he appointed those who should sing to the LORD, and who should praise the beauty of holiness, as they went out before the army and were saying: “Praise the LORD, For His mercy endures forever.”***

This strange battle strategy accomplished four distinct things:

- The battle strategy built the faith of the people... Fear dissipated as praise took

precedence! Their praise helped them believe their mission would be successful!

- The battle strategy mystified the enemy... The praise of the people caused confusion in the unholy alliance of the Ammonites, Moabites, and the Children of Mt. Seir! Ammon and Moab attacked and destroyed the inhabitants of Mt. Seir! Once the Children of Mt. Seir were dead, Ammon and Moab took turns destroying each other! Praise is God's jamming device to confuse the communication channels of the demonic spirits of Hell, who are bent on the destruction of the people of God! This interruption in the ability of the enemy to properly communicate with his cronies brought about their destruction! If we want to win our battle against the enemy, we must get busy praising God!
- The battle strategy caused God to get involved in the battle... The praise caused God to show up and it was His presence that turned the enemy against each other! Not

only did the enemy kill each other, the Bible say's "***The LORD set ambushes against the people of Ammon, Moab, and Mount Seir, who had come against Judah; and they were defeated.***" I can assure us, there was an angel with a sword in hand, behind every bush! Praise activates the indispensable element of the Heavenly host fighting for the people who are praising God! We are Gods children and when we choose to focus on praising Him, rather than focusing on the difficulty, God shows up and He shows out! The Word of God makes this clear when it states, "***Let God arise and His enemies be scattered!***" My personal interpretation of that verse is "*When God gets up, His enemies are gonna get it!!!*" (My Dad used to say, "*Don't make me get up from here!*") Our praise brings God to His feet; Jesus to our rescue; the Holy Spirit to our side; Heaven to attention; and the angels camp out around us until the battle is complete, and the spoils have been gathered!

- The battle strategy created bountiful blessings for Judah... ***“When Jehoshaphat and his people came to take away their spoil, they found among them an abundance of valuables on the dead bodies, and precious jewelry, which they stripped off for themselves, more than they could carry away; and they were three days gathering the spoil because there was so much.”*** The will of God is far greater than for His people to win a battle; His will is for us to end the battle on a victorious note, and then gather the spoils! How is this possible? Praise Him before the battle starts; praise Him while the battle rages; praise Him when the battle is complete; praise Him in all things and in every place, never quit praising God!

I consider myself a true worshipper! I have a heart of worship, but I want us to understand what all is riding on our praise. For the child of God, praise is the difference between success

and failure; victory and defeat; life and death!
We must choose life, victory, and success, by
choosing to praise God!

God created humankind for the purpose of
praise! Isaiah 43:21 states that God has formed
for himself a people "*...That they may
proclaim My (God's) praise.*" The verse does
not stop there, it goes on to say "*And they shall
do it.*"

In giving oneself to praise, the worshiper
declares his/her total alignment with God's
purposes. Praise, is the only thing fit for
God! Praise, is both a duty and a delight.
Psalms 63:3-8 (NKJV) "*Because Your
lovingkindness is better than life, My lips
shall praise You. ⁴Thus I will bless You
while I live; I will lift up my hands in Your
name. ⁵*My soul shall be satisfied as with*
marrow and fatness, And my mouth shall
praise You with joyful lips. ⁶*When I*
*remember You on my bed, I meditate on**

You in the night watches.⁷ Because You have been my help, Therefore in the shadow of Your wings I will rejoice.⁸ My soul follows close behind You; Your right hand upholds me.”

We must strive to be the kind of people who live a life of praise to the point there is a Holy overflow from our hearts and spirits toward our Father, because of who He is! Our praise cannot just be an internal thing, it must also be an external expression so that others will come to know us as worshippers!

Whenever and wherever God’s people praise Him, He reigns among them and does miraculous things on their behalf. I trust this will continue to be an identifying mark of CT Church! I hope we will not settle down! I want our praise and worship to intensify every time we come together!

Be warned, if one decides not to be a person of praise, and a worshipper of God, that person

will not take away from His Glory, they will only shut themselves out from His presence, protection, and provision!

C.S. Lewis said, *“A man can no more diminish God's glory by refusing to worship Him than a lunatic can put out the sun by scribbling the word, 'darkness' on the walls of his cell.”*

I predict that if we want to find God in 2021, all we must do is to start praising Him and He will be there!

PREDICTION # 10 - THE COMING OF THE LORD WILL CONTINUE TO BE THE MOST ANTICIPATED EVENT OF THE CHURCH

John 14:1-3 (KJV) *“Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me.² In my Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you.³ And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and*

receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.” Here in John chapter fourteen Jesus is conditioning His Disciples to the fact that He will be leaving them very soon. One of the things He says to them, which was specifically designed to bring cheer to their hearts, and smiles to their faces; is the promise, *“I will come again.”* More than twenty centuries have come and gone and when I read those words it produces hope in my heart, and causes a smile to break out on my face!

This world is in big trouble, but let me remind us, everything is working according to Gods calendar! A lot of people want to know what is about to happen, and I want to take a few minutes to tell you exactly what is about to transpire!

Take heart weary pilgrim, Jesus left a promise to ***“Come again!”*** We cannot afford to:

- Quit...
- Give up...

- Become discouraged...
- Think of turning back...

We must hold to Gods unchanging hand! His promises are absolutely accurate! He is coming again!

1 Thessalonians 4:13-18 (KJV) ***“But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope. ¹⁴For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him. ¹⁵For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep. ¹⁶For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first: ¹⁷Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the***

Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord. ¹⁸Wherefore comfort one another with these words.”

1 Corinthians 15:51-58 (KJV) *“Behold, I shew you a mystery; We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed, ⁵²In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump: for the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.*

⁵³For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality. ⁵⁴So when this corruptible shall have put on incorruption, and this mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written, Death is swallowed up in victory. ⁵⁵O death, where is thy sting? O grave, where is thy victory? ⁵⁶The sting of death is sin; and the strength of sin is the law. ⁵⁷But thanks be to God, which giveth us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ. ⁵⁸Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the

work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.”

He did not leave us comfortless! He provides everything we need to make it through whatever we are called upon to endure!

There is no need for us to allow our circumstances or surroundings to discourage us! God has placed us where we are but He assured us He would ***“Come again!”***

I predict the coming of the Lord will continue to be the most anticipated event on the calendar of Christians around the world in 2021!